PPP / WEBSITE STRATEGY & DESIGN

A considered beginning.

A curated jewellery storefront, a personal consultation journey, and the decisions that connect them.

Founder review · 7 October 2026
Prepared for the SiteWide project

Prototype only. The working identity, illustrations, catalogue and prices are examples. No live orders, enquiries or payments are accepted.

Website specification — founder review

Prepared 7 October 2026. Recommendations and planning estimates are distinguished from verified source facts in `research.md`.

Recommendation

Build a mobile-first Indian jewellery boutique around a deliberately small edit. Gold-plated silver is the principal online category. Lightweight real-gold pieces, mainly 18K with selected 22K designs, support everyday and impulse purchases. A festive line serves occasion purchases. Higher-value and bridal pieces use an assisted consultation route.

Online discovery can target India, with delivery limited to serviceable, insured pincodes. Local consultations focus on Erode, Tirupur, Coimbatore and Karur. Do not advertise guaranteed home service across every pincode in these cities before the parent company's team and suppliers confirm coverage.

The primary digital audience is women and men in their 20s through their mid-40s. The below-₹30,000 range should be easy to browse. The founder has not set festive price bands or the final assortment size.

1. Identity and theme

Recommended direction: quiet contemporary design with restrained Indian warmth.

Element	Direction
Canvas	Warm ivory `#F6F3EC`, paper `#FFFCF6`, sand `#E8DFD0`
Text and emphasis	Ink `#292723`; plum `#482B3B`; antique gold `#96743C`
Typography	Expressive serif headlines, clear sans-serif descriptions and commerce controls
Photography	Accurate close-ups; scale on real people; a mix of women and men; natural skin tones
Styling	Everyday clothing and restrained festive settings; textiles and architectural references used selectively
Layout	Spacious editorial introductions followed by concise, usable product information
Motion	Subtle feedback; respect reduced-motion preferences
Voice	Warm, informed and precise about materials; explain curation without implying exclusive manufacture

The offline preview uses system fonts and original SVG illustrations so it can be downloaded and opened without external services. Production typography and imagery will follow final identity approval and asset licensing.

`THE EDIT` is a temporary wordmark for review. The new brand name, logo and domain are still being developed. Introduce the parent brand through Our Story only. Use its verified history without inventing a founding year, location reach or supplier relationship.

2. Catalogue architecture

Organise discovery by use and collection. Keep material labels visible everywhere.

Collection	Role
Everyday	Regular-wear pieces with the below-₹30,000 range prominent
Small Gold — working name	Lightweight real-gold creations; predominantly 18K, selected 22K
Festive	Occasion pieces with separate pricing to be decided
The Edit	A small curated selection, refreshed when actual stock and demand justify it
Private Appointments	Higher-value, wedding and bridal enquiry journey

One product can appear in several collections while retaining one inventory record. Filters should include category, material, price, purity where relevant, and ready-stock/made-to-order status. Do not offer filter choices that contain no relevant products at launch.

Avoid using the ambiguous term "one-gram jewellery" as the sole product description. The founder has clarified that this category contains real gold. List 18K or 22K explicitly, and publish verified net metal weight for each SKU. Whether the approximate one-gram intention refers to alloy weight or pure-gold content remains to be confirmed from supplier specifications; never infer it from purity alone.

The visual prototype demonstrates four invented products. It does not recommend these exact designs, prices or stock levels. The budget assumes approximately 30 launch designs solely to size the work.

3. Sitemap and homepage

Primary navigation: Shop, The Edit, Private Appointments, Our Story. Search and bag are utility controls. Account access is optional for launch; guest checkout should remain straightforward.

Production pages:

1. Home.
2. Shop and collection pages.
3. Product detail template with material-specific fields.
4. Cart and hosted checkout.
5. Appointment explanation and request form.
6. Our Story.
7. Care and material guide.
8. Contact and order support.
9. Delivery, returns, warranty, privacy and terms pages.
10. Order confirmation and appointment acknowledgement.

Homepage sequence: editorial introduction → curated products → Small Gold story → festive selection → private appointments → Our Story invitation. Product and service pages carry relevant trust details beside the decision, not solely in the footer.

English is the launch language. Prepare translation fields from the start; Tamil is the recommended next language for the local consultation audience. Publish only reviewed translations. Additional languages should follow demonstrated demand.

4. Customer journeys

Ready-stock purchase

Acquisition page → relevant collection → product → variant/quantity → cart → serviceable delivery address → final charges → online payment → confirmation → dispatch and delivery updates → care/support.

Stock must be decremented consistently across the website and parent-store operations. A displayed ready-stock promise must reflect stock that the business controls or has reserved.

Made-to-order or supplier-sourced purchase

Product → explicit fulfilment status and lead time → confirmed specifications and fixed price → payment → milestone updates → dispatch.

If the supplier cannot confirm price or availability, use an enquiry/quote action instead of taking immediate payment. Quote validity and permissible cancellation/return terms must be clear before acceptance.

WhatsApp assistance

Product → customer initiates assistance with product reference → staff answers → secure payment/checkout route. Marketing opt-in is separate from assistance or order notifications. Do not automatically subscribe customers to broadcasts.

High-value consultation

Service page → name/contact/city/interests/budget/preferred timing → staff review → necessary verification → store/home eligibility decision → confirmed appointment → supplier/staff coordination → consultation → quote/payment/invoice and follow-up.

Store and home visits are distinct choices. A submitted enquiry is not a confirmed booking. Do not collect identity-document uploads on the initial public form. Establish any later verification process, retention and access rules with the responsible team.

5. Product-page specification

- Material displayed beside the title and price.
- Multiple photographs, on-body scale and an optional short wearing video.
- Purity, net metal weight, dimensions and stone details where relevant.

- Base metal and plating details for plated items; do not describe gold-plated silver as solid gold.
- Ready-stock, made-to-order or supplier-confirmation status.
- Actual price and valid variants; lead time and delivery eligibility.
- Applicable hallmark or supplier documentation described per item after validation.
- Care guidance and warranty scope supported by the supplier.
- Concise return eligibility and timing, linked to the complete policy.
- Online purchase and customer-initiated assistance where appropriate.

No unverified claims such as universally waterproof, hypoallergenic, lifetime plating, guaranteed investment returns or sitewide BIS certification. Claims require supporting specifications and applicable legal review.

6. Operations

No COD. Shortlist UPI/card checkout and a jewellery-specialist insured delivery arrangement. BVC is a research candidate, not an appointed supplier. Obtain written terms for accepted materials, value limits, serviceable pincodes, pickup requirements, custody, loss claims and reverse logistics before selection.

Free-delivery eligibility should be derived from actual contribution margin. Do not publish a rupee threshold until approved.

Returns: request inside a published window → eligibility decision → authorised return transport → receipt and documented inspection → outcome communication → refund if approved. Publish a defined inspection and refund turnaround; avoid an indefinite inspection condition. Distinguish change-of-mind requests from defects, incorrect items and applicable consumer obligations. Final rules require an Indian consumer-law review.

Admin data: SKU, supplier reference, material, purity, weight, images, cost, selling price, quantity, sourcing mode, lead time, documentation, return eligibility and appointment owner/status. Assign individual staff roles; do not rely on a shared owner login.

7. Platform decision

Start from a tailored Shopify theme because the intended workflow requires catalogue, orders and owner-operated commerce. Use standard platform functionality before commissioning custom services. This prototype is not a deployable Shopify theme.

Important commercial finding: current official pages list a 2% third-party-provider fee on Shopify Basic and standard Razorpay gateway pricing of 2% + GST. The two fees are separate. An approximate 4% combined headline cost before applicable fee taxes can be material for gold margins; billing bases, payment methods and merchant-specific terms must be confirmed. See the linked research and editable model.

Basic may suit an initial single-admin pilot. Grow lists up to five staff accounts and a lower 1% third-party-provider fee. Based on annual-billing subscription prices, the incremental subscription cost is offset at approximately ₹4.10 lakh/month of equally eligible transaction volume, before taxes and other differences. Staff access may independently justify the plan change.

Final gate: real product contribution margins, expected transaction volume, needed staff roles, merchant approval and provider terms. If total fees make the model unattractive, compare a managed WooCommerce option with an actual maintenance quote before committing; no verified WooCommerce cost comparison is included here.

8. Scope, cost and schedule

The budget spreadsheet allocates ₹1.45–₹3.20 lakh before contingency, or approximately ₹1.7–₹3.7 lakh with 15% contingency. Reserve ₹2.5–₹3 lakh provisionally. These are planning allowances for externally commissioned work, not market quotations or charges from the assistant. Implementing together may reduce contractor spending.

Exclusions: inventory, GST/taxes, advertising, exhibitions, transaction fees, shipping, insurance, returns, ongoing human support and unusual integrations. Avoid double-counting an agency's integration/testing work if already included in its development quote.

Software reserve: ₹3,000–₹10,000/month, subject to plan and app choices; this is an estimate, not a platform price. Verified subscription prices are listed separately in the research.

Stage	Indicative duration	Gate
Research, requirements and operations decisions	3–5 working days	Fees and product model are acceptable
Identity application and page design	5–7 working days	Founder approves desktop/mobile design
Store implementation and integrations	8–12 working days	Sandbox order and enquiry paths function
Catalogue, policies and launch checks	4–6 working days	Real data, provider approvals and operations are ready

Allow roughly 4–6 weeks with prompt decisions and available assets. These are estimates, not a delivery commitment. Supplier onboarding or brand photography may extend the schedule.

9. Launch acceptance criteria

- All published products have correct material, purity where relevant, price, supplier-backed specifications and images.
- Ready-stock orders and supplier-confirmation enquiries follow different paths correctly.
- UPI/card success, failure and duplicate-callback behaviour are tested in the chosen provider's supported test mode.
- Inventory and confirmation emails remain correct after successful and failed payments.
- COD is unavailable; delivery eligibility and final charges are clear before payment.
- Refund and return workflows are exercised with authorised test orders.
- Appointment enquiry reaches the responsible person without implying automatic home-visit approval.
- Keyboard navigation, labels, focus, mobile layout, readable contrast and reduced motion are checked.
- Analytics captures agreed commerce events without logging sensitive customer details.
- Policies, documentation claims, privacy and material-specific disclosures are approved before publication.

Optional later work: loyalty, complex product personalisation, automated WhatsApp campaigns, advanced CRM, live metal-rate pricing, full catalogue translation and designer-drop infrastructure. These are not part of the initial prototype.

10. Immediate decisions

Review the visual direction and flows in the prototype. Then confirm the brand name, real launch catalogue, precise weight conventions, cost/margin sheet, fulfilment promises, return terms, free-delivery threshold, staff roles, launch date and platform spend. These decisions do not prevent concept review; they do prevent a truthful production launch.

The wider market report, 12-brand comparison, business financials and 12-month launch programme from the original brief are deferred as the founder requested.

Website decision research

Accessed 7 October 2026, Asia/Kolkata. Official pages were retrieved directly after the environment's research-domain configuration was applied. Findings describe published information on this date, not a merchant-specific quotation, commercial endorsement or legal opinion.

Verified platform and payment facts

Finding	Source	Website implication
Shopify Basic lists ₹1,499/month on annual billing, or ₹1,994/month on monthly billing. Its third-party payment-provider fee is 2%.	Shopify India pricing	The subscription is only one part of commerce cost. Annual-billing monthly equivalents imply an annual commitment.
Grow lists ₹5,599/month on annual billing, ₹7,447/month on monthly billing, a 1% third-party-provider fee and up to five staff accounts.	Shopify India pricing	Compare transaction volume and actual staff needs before choosing Basic.
India was absent from the Shopify Payments supported-country list retrieved on this date.	Supported countries	Plan around an eligible third-party provider unless support changes. Country eligibility and merchant approval must be rechecked at activation.
Razorpay's pricing FAQ describes standard 2% + GST gateway pricing and zero setup/annual-maintenance charges. The page also advertises conditional introductory/custom offers.	Razorpay pricing	Budget using durable standard pricing, not an assumed promotion. Obtain a merchant-specific quote; special methods and services can differ.
Shopify Translate & Adapt is listed as free; its description offers automatic translation for up to two languages and manual translation additions.	Official app listing	Evaluate it for the English/Tamil plan. This does not prove every theme, app, field or workflow is translated correctly; Tamil and checkout coverage require testing.

Cost calculation — derived, not a vendor quotation

Assuming Shopify's and the gateway's fees apply to the same eligible value, Basic 2% plus a standard 2% gateway charge produces an approximate 4% headline combined rate before applicable taxes on fees. At an illustrative ₹15,000 eligible transaction value, that is ₹600 before applicable fee taxes. Actual billing bases and exclusions can differ; this is not the customer's product GST calculation.

Annual-billing plan comparison: `(5599 - 1499) / (0.02 - 0.01) = ₹410,000` eligible monthly transaction volume. Above this simplified break-even, the 1 percentage-point fee reduction can offset the ₹4,100 subscription difference. With monthly-billing subscriptions the analogous threshold is `(7447 - 1994) / 0.01 = ₹545,300`.

These calculations exclude taxes, additional features, negotiated gateway rates and noneligible transactions. Staff-account requirements may determine the plan independently. The CSV model makes these assumptions editable. Current promotions and credits are excluded.

Delivery candidate

BVC Logistics redirects to bvclogistics.com and describes secure domestic logistics, secure fulfilment and ecommerce last-mile services for gems and jewellery. This establishes relevance as a candidate; it does not confirm a quote, reverse-pickup service for this business, insurance coverage, serviceable locations, value limits or integration readiness.

Before selection, obtain written answers on dispatch from Erode, insured nationwide delivery coverage, precious versus plated item acceptance, shipment ceilings, returns custody, tamper evidence, claims, pickup SLAs, platform integration and customer charges.

Website references

These are focused structural references, not a full competitor study. No third-party images or logos have been copied into the prototype. Page content was inspected; no conversion performance, sales, traffic or social-media metrics are claimed.

Official reference	Observed website structure	Transferable lesson	Do not copy
Quirksmith	Named narrative collections and new drops; material-oriented browsing including silver and gold-plated brass; material/service information appears on the homepage.	Give small edits a clear story and disclose materials where shoppers choose.	Its distinctive language-led product identity, large navigation structure or current promotional tactics. Its material choices are not the founder's product specifications.
MISHO	Navigation combines jewellery forms and named edits; support links include shipping, returns, warranty and product care.	Combine use/type browsing with editorial collections and accessible service information.	Protected designs, photography, naming or identity. A luxury reference does not establish the proposed brand's pricing power.

The proposed ivory/plum palette and original illustrations are design recommendations, not claims about either reference brand's current visual palette.

Hallmarking and disclosure verification

The initially attempted FAQ URL `https://www.bis.gov.in/hallmarking-overview/faq-hallmarking/` returned HTTP 403. The BIS homepage and hallmarking overview were accessible through alternate official paths. The overview exposes links to regulations, mandatory orders, exemptions and jeweller-registration material. The homepage navigation includes a regulation amendment labelled 14 September 2026.

An overview or navigation label does not establish which rule applies to an individual plated-silver or approximately one-gram gold item. Current applicability, exemptions, registration, HUID/invoice requirements and supplier documentation remain **uncertain — needs source and item-specific review**. Do not infer that every SKU must or can carry the same hallmark, or publish a blanket BIS-certified claim.

The website therefore needs separate material, purity, weight and documentation fields per SKU. The parent jeweller should supply evidence, and an appropriately qualified Indian adviser should confirm current obligations before launch. Return-policy and privacy-law compliance also require review; no legal rule or statutory time limit has been asserted in this kit.

Recommendations versus unresolved facts

- Verified: published platform/gateway prices and features described above; official candidate/reference page structures.
- Founder-supplied: location, audience, product direction, purity mix, sourcing model and no-COD preference.
- Recommendations: theme, collection architecture, Tamil as first additional language, platform starting point and service flows.
- Estimates: build budget, ongoing software reserve, catalogue size assumption and schedule.
- Unresolved: final product costs/margins, supplier specs, carrier quote/coverage, merchant approval, actual return rules, legal applicability, brand assets and launch date.

The original request's complete business plan and twelve-brand research comparison are intentionally outside this website-first delivery.

Decision record

Confirmed by the founder

- Use SiteWide for the project and provide downloadable files. The earlier local-Desktop-only preference is superseded.
- Gold-plated silver is the principal online category in the original brief.
- The approximately one-gram concept contains real gold; mostly 18K with some 22K designs.
- Everyday purchases below ₹30,000 and a festive line are important.
- Online audience: women and men in their 20s to mid-40s; national targeting.
- Parent business is in Erode. High-value/home-consultation focus: Erode, Tirupur, Coimbatore, Karur.
- Parent-brand endorsement belongs in Our Story.
- Mix ready stock and made-to-order/supplier-sourced products.
- Existing market-sourced jewellery first; own/designer collections later.
- A blend of quiet contemporary and modern Indian visual themes.
- English first; multilingual support desired.
- Online checkout plus WhatsApp assistance; no COD.
- Free-delivery threshold to be considered; specialist jewellery logistics desired.
- Short return request window, with refund after return and quality confirmation; exact lawful policy not yet defined.
- Parent-company staff and suppliers handle high-value enquiries.
- Website-first research now; wider business plan separately.

Recommendations for review, not founder-approved commitments

- Ivory/plum/antique-gold design direction as shown in the prototype.
- Shopify starting point, subject to commercial and operational checks.
- Tamil as the first additional language.
- Approximately 30 designs as the budget's scope assumption.
- ₹2.5–₹3 lakh launch reserve, within the detailed ₹1.7–₹3.7 lakh planning range.
- Roughly 4–6 weeks once assets, approvals and suppliers are available.

Still needed before production

1. Brand name, logo, domain and approved story; `THE EDIT` is a placeholder.
2. Actual product catalogue, photographs, variants, costs and margins.

3. Verified net weights, plating/base-metal specs and documentation per SKU; clarify alloy-weight versus fine-gold content.
4. Confirmed ready-stock and supplier lead-time promises.
5. Shopify plan, staff roles, gateway account/approval and all-in fee acceptance.
6. Specialist carrier terms, insurance/value limits, delivery and reverse-logistics coverage.
7. Free-delivery threshold and final return/exchange/warranty policy with defined turnaround.
8. Home-visit qualification, verification, custody, safety and data-retention process.
9. Launch date, responsible catalogue/support staff and actual spending approvals.

No new questions are required to review the concept. Unresolved operational decisions remain visible rather than being replaced with invented values.

Budget worksheet

Planning estimates for commissioned work, not vendor quotes. The editable CSV includes formulas. The monthly software reserve is separate from the one-time total.

Workstream	Low, INR	High, INR	Scope / status
Brand identity essentials	20,000	45,000	Planning estimate. Logo direction and core visual system
Website design and theme implementation	60,000	130,000	Planning estimate. Tailored commerce theme; approximately 30 designs assumed
Photography and short videos	30,000	70,000	Planning estimate. Actual deliverables and shoot scope require quote
Copy catalogue and translation review	15,000	30,000	Planning estimate. English first; limited reviewed translation scope
Operational integration and launch testing	20,000	45,000	Planning estimate. Avoid double counting if agency includes this in build quote
Subtotal	145,000	320,000	Formula. Excludes taxes inventory advertising fulfilment and transaction costs
Contingency	21,750	48,000	Formula. 15 percent planning contingency
Total	166,750	368,000	Formula. External commissioning allowance; not a charge from the assistant
Monthly software reserve	3,000	10,000	Separate monthly estimate. Not included in one-time total; actual platform and apps determine cost

Based on the annual-billing platform model at illustrative monthly eligible volume of ₹5,00,000: Basic plus 2% gateway = ₹21,499 before applicable taxes; Grow plus the same gateway = ₹20,599. Difference: ₹900 per month. These are equal-fee-base scenarios, not invoices.

The wider market and business plan is deferred. Current-source facts, founder requirements, recommendations and estimates are distinguished throughout. No production launch or legal compliance certification is claimed.